SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

A TRACER STUDY OF BLIS GRADUATES: BASIS FOR CURRICULUM ENHANCEMENT

A Thesis Presented To
The faculty of
College of Computing and Information Sciences

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF LIBRARY AND INFORMATION SCIENCE

By

Sheila Joyce M. Rosal
Emirald V. Sabandal
Leah Mae D. Delapena
Kimberly G. Rodriguez
Mary Grace T. Ouano

ADVISER: Kristine Mae Celeres

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CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis, entitled " **A TRACER STUDY OF BLIS GRADUATES: BASIS FOR CURRICULUM ENHANCEMENT"** was presented and submitted by **Sheila Joyce M. Rosal, Emirald V. Sabandal, Leah Mae D. Delape**ña, Kimberly G. Rodriguez, and Mary Grace T. Ouano In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Library and Information Science** Is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

KRISTINE MAE CELERES, RL
Adviser

LANI JANE E. LUMOGDA, RL
Member

DAISA O. GUPIT
Member

PRINCESS VARONA
Chairperson

ACCEPTED as partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Library and Information Science**

APPROVED by the tribunal at the Oral Examination with the grade of _____.

KRISTINE MAE CELERES, RL
Adviser

LANI JANE E. LUMOGDA, RL
Member

DAISA O. GUPIT
Member

PRINCESS VARONA
Chairperson

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

Nasipit, Agusan del Norte

College Of Computing and Information Sciences

ABSTRACT

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AUTHOR/S:	Sheila Joyce M. Rosal Emirald V. Sabandal Leah Mae D. Delapena Mary Grace T. Ouano Kimberly G. Rodriguez
DEGREE:	Bachelor of Library and Information Science
ADVISER:	Kristine Mae Celeres, RL
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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) program is increasingly relevant today as it provides various career opportunities (Tian and Chen 2024). It aims to develop the Knowledge, Skills, Attitudes, and Values (KSAV) needed to become competent information professionals (Asid, 2023a). LIS programs play a crucial role in developing employability skills and preparing graduates for professional growth, underscoring their value and importance (Sadueste et al., 2025a). The study emphasized the need to strengthen the curriculum to ensure that graduates' competencies align with industry demands.

Globally, higher education institutions worldwide have the challenge of adapting their academic programs to rapid technological advancements and labor market demands. The Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) curriculum is designed to provide students with skills in information organization, retrieval, management, and digital literacy (International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions, 2023). However, as libraries include artificial intelligence, data analytics, and digital curation, the relevance of traditional LIS courses is called into uncertainty (Ameen, 2025a). The need for technology integration in LIS programs is urgent and essential, as international studies show that how well academic programs embed KSAV that align with industry expectations has a significant impact on LIS graduates' employability and career paths (Adegbilero-Iwari, 2023a).

UNESCO (2023) underscores the importance of integrating employability skills—communication, teamwork, critical thinking, and technological proficiency—into LIS programs to ensure graduates can navigate complex, technology-driven job environments. Despite these observations, many LIS programs worldwide continue to focus on academic foundations rather than the applied aspects of librarianship (Rani and Sharma, 2022). Hence, the need to urgently scrutinize the alignment between curricular offerings and graduate outcomes has become a pressing academic priority.

Moreover, various studies have been conducted to measure LIS graduates' readiness for the global information environment. According to a study conducted by IFLA (2023), LIS professionals must have an extensive understanding of data governance, digital preservation, and user-centered design, as well as research, information ethics, and digital literacy skills. Similarly, Ameen (2021b), highlighted the growing need to cultivate adaptive attitudes and ethical stewardship ideals in the face of emerging digital risks. Furthermore, Chu (2022), found that LIS graduates with balanced KSAV profiles are more employable and capable of contributing to institutional knowledge management. Despite these findings, many foreign programs continue to struggle with keeping curricular content consistent with real-world professional requirements (Adegbilero-Iwari, 2023b). Graduates usually have strong theoretical knowledge but little exposure to emerging technologies such as integrated library systems, digital repositories, and knowledge management tools (Mendoza, 2025).

Also, Lwoga and Ngulube (2022) have noted that many LIS institutions, notably those in Asia and Africa, continue to experience a gap between academic preparation and industry success. Graduates frequently claim theoretical understanding but lack practical experience with digital systems, information architecture, and research analytics, indicating a long-standing curriculum

practice gap that hinders employability and professional adaptability. MeanwhileAguilar and Torres (2023a) investigated the employability of LIS graduates from various Philippine colleges; few have carefully evaluated how KSAV translates into actual work performance and career success at the local institutional level. This study bridges that gap by not only tracking graduates' work routes but also pinpointing specific curricular areas that need to be improved, such as resource and capability skills, system, and technology.

The (Commission on Higher Education (CHED) established outcomes-based education (OBE) frameworks in CHED Memorandum Order (CMO) No. 24. 2015, focusing on the development of KSAV among BLIS students to improve knowledge management, ethical awareness, and digital competency (Aguilar and Torres (2023b). Furthermore, local studies have assessed the employability and skill alignment of LIS graduates from various institutions, identifying both strengths and deficiencies. De la Pena and Jamon (2021) discovered that BLIS graduates in the Visayas excelled at cataloging and classification but lacked advanced abilities in digital librarianship and data analysis. Tracer analyses are critical for determining whether graduates have the skills required of them and for identifying opportunities for curriculum improvement as academic institutions aim to align their programs with the needs of the global job market (Pangilinan and Sumaylo, 2019).

Kassim, Katunzi-Mollel, and Mwantimwa (2022) found that although many graduates valued lifelong learning and professional ethics, they needed more exposure to emerging technologies. According to Galleto and Sumile (2023),Mindanao LIS graduates frequently encounter issues in connecting their KSAV with the competencies required by employers in digital and hybrid library contexts. Despite the institution's commitment to academic accomplishment, concerns remain about the curriculum alignment with the practical demands of the workplace.

Graduate employability and competency application in the professional sector are key indicators of how well the curriculum prepares students for real-world difficulties (Del Mundo, 2020).

Therefore, the main objective of this study is to assess the effectiveness of the BLIS curriculum at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) by tracing the employment status, Knowledge, Skills, Attitudes, Values (KSAV), and employability skills of its graduates from 2022 to 2025. The findings will serve as a basis for curriculum enhancement to ensure that the academic preparation provided by the institution aligns with the expectations of employers and the evolving needs of the information profession and establish a responsive framework for continuous improvement in BLIS education, ensuring that graduates have not only academic proficiency but also practical adaptability, resourcefulness, and technological competence, all of which are essential in the changing information landscape.

The significance of this study lies in its potential to benefit stakeholders. For school administrators, the findings will provide a vital basis for assessing the curriculum and enhancing the BLIS program. The findings will help ensure that the curriculum remains relevant to current developments in the information industry and that graduates' KSAV competencies are effectively developed. For faculty, the findings will serve as a foundation for aligning learning outcomes with industry demands. For employers and partner institutions, the research will highlight key competencies and areas of collaboration for internship and job placement. For students, the study highlights the relevance of developing a balanced KSAV profile as a foundation for professional growth and lifelong learning. Lastly, for future researchers, the study will give empirical data and methodological insights that can be used as references for future research on LIS education, graduate employability, and curriculum evaluation. Future studies may build on this work by investigating the long-term consequences of curricular adjustments or comparing KSAV outcomes

across institutions and regions. Ultimately, this study seeks to improve LIS education in the Philippines by ensuring that graduates of the BLIS program at Saint Michael College of Caraga possess the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values needed to thrive in an ever-changing information landscape.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This section contains a review of related literature relevant to the present study. Understanding literature and previous tracer studies is essential for contextualizing the career outcomes of Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) graduates. Tracer studies are critical mechanisms used worldwide to assess the relevance and effectiveness of an academic curriculum by examining graduates' employment status, time-to-job placement, and job conformity. Accordingly, the literature review explores three major domains: the demographic profile, KSAs acquired in the LIS program, and employability skills. These findings serve as a

fundamental benchmark for interpreting data from the current cohort of BLIS graduates and formulating evidence-based recommendations for curriculum enhancement.

Bachelor of Library and Information Sciences

The Bachelor of Library and Information science (BLIS) is a comprehensive four-year undergraduate program design to equip aspiring librarians and information professionals with the essential knowledge, skills and competencies needed to effectively manage, organize, preserve and disseminate various types of information resources whether in print or digital form. As the information and communication technology (ICT) are rapidly developing, the scope of library and information science (LIS) expanded, with other skills, competencies, and professional-level roles (Abdullahi and Haruna 2020).

The Commission on Higher Education (CHED) provides the academic framework and quality standards for LIS education through CHED Memorandum Order (CMO) No. 24, series of 2015. This memorandum outlines the goals, outcomes, and competencies expected of BLIS graduates, emphasizing the development of professionals who are not only technically skilled but also ethical, innovative, and responsive to the changing demands of the information landscape. It ensures that BLIS programs produce graduates who can adapt to the dynamic needs of libraries, information centers, and knowledge-based institutions in the 21st century (CHED, 2015).

Knowledge of Library Management

Knowledge management in academic libraries extends beyond the simple organization and storage of materials; it involves cultivating a knowledge of culture, integrating innovative practices, and enhancing staff competencies. According to Rafi, Zheng, & Ahmad (2022), knowledge

management (KM) plays a pivotal role in improving the technical and professional capabilities of library staff, ultimately guiding institutional decision-making. This underscores the idea that libraries should not only store knowledge but actively manage and use it to advance both operational and service excellence in higher education institutions.

Staff development programs are equally critical for expanding library personnel's knowledge base, especially in management functions such as human resources, finance, and reader services. Academic libraries that invest in continuous staff training achieve higher service delivery quality. These findings highlight that effective library management depends on personnel who possess both administrative and technical knowledge, as these competencies contribute to improved organizational performance and user satisfaction (Awogbami et al., 2021).

The Integrated Knowledge Management Framework has been identified as a vital tool for enhancing the management of digital resources and the productivity of library staff. Rafi, Zheng, & Ahmad (2022) argued that explicit knowledge and a strong knowledge-sharing culture are fundamental components of efficient information management systems. Implementing such frameworks enables academic libraries to align management strategies with institutional goals, improve access to resources, and foster innovation in service delivery.

However, despite the recognized importance of knowledge management, its implementation remains a challenge due to conceptual ambiguity and limited empirical understanding. Found that many library institutions struggle to effectively apply KM strategies such as codification, personalization, and knowledge harvesting. These methods are designed to facilitate knowledge flow within organizations, yet their inconsistent application hampers the overall efficiency of library management systems (Abah et al., 2022).

In modern academic contexts, knowledge is considered a strategic resource essential to effective library management. Rexwhite (2025) highlighted that librarians' ability to manage both explicit and tacit knowledge influences the quality-of-service delivery. The exchange of non-documented knowledge and collaborative learning among librarians enhances operational efficiency, supports innovation, and strengthens the institution's adaptability to evolving information needs.

Furthermore, management competencies, particularly at the leadership level, are essential for sustaining library operations. Managerial knowledge in areas such as technology integration, diversity, and inclusion is vital for modern librarianship. Continuing education programs that focus on these areas improve both administrative capability and overall service effectiveness, demonstrating the interconnection between knowledge acquisition and library management success (Moen et al., 2020)

Goddard (2020) revealed that effective knowledge management practices directly impact innovation and organizational learning within academic libraries. When management fosters a supportive environment and uses technology for knowledge sharing, staff members are better able to adapt to institutional changes. This reinforces the significance of knowledge preservation and dissemination as integral elements of library management that drive both institutional growth and professional development.

Skills in the Profession of Librarianship

The profession of librarianship has evolved significantly in response to the demands of the digital age, requiring Library and Information Science (LIS) professionals to possess a multifaceted set of skills encompassing both traditional and emerging competencies. Yadav (2021) emphasized that professionals must demonstrate proficiency not only in cataloging, classification, and

information retrieval but also in research, computing, and data management. The development of these skill sets ensures that librarians remain adaptable and effective in managing digital resources, automation systems, and online services. Moreover, soft skills such as communication and teamwork have been highlighted as equally vital, fostering collaborative environments, and enhancing the delivery of library services.

In the context of libraries' digital transformation, Subaveeranpandiyan, Sinha, and Ugwulebo (2024) underscore the growing importance of digital literacy as a core competency for LIS professionals. Their study revealed that although many librarians possess basic digital skills, there remains a significant gap in advanced capabilities essential to efficient digital library management. This finding underscores the need for continuous professional development and curriculum updates to ensure graduates possess both fundamental and advanced digital competencies. The integration of digital literacy into library education curricula thus becomes critical for preparing future librarians to meet the challenges of the rapidly changing technological landscape.

Leadership skills are a crucial component of librarianship, particularly in micro libraries undergoing significant technological shifts. Effective library leadership relies on a combination of technical expertise, interpersonal competence, and visionary thinking. Librarians must exhibit strong communication abilities, adaptability, and collaborative leadership to guide their institutions through periods of digital transformation. Continuous learning and mentorship are vital to enhancing leadership potential, ensuring that both experienced and emerging professionals can effectively manage evolving user expectations and institutions effectively (Ashiq et al., 2021).

Communication skills, as pointed out by Sumaiya et al. (2022), are fundamental to professional success in librarianship. The ability to clearly convey information, engage effectively with patrons, and maintain productive relationships with colleagues greatly influences overall service quality. Effective communication not only strengthens internal coordination within libraries but also improves external partnerships with stakeholders. Consequently, communication competence should be integrated into library training and professional development programs to complement technical expertise and ensure holistic professional growth.

In specialized fields such as health sciences librarianship, the scope of professional skills expands even further. Capdarest-Arest and Gray (2020) found that medical librarians are increasingly required to demonstrate interprofessional leadership and collaboration across disciplines. Their study highlighted that successful medical librarians possess not only traditional library management and information organization skills but also cross-disciplinary communication and leadership capabilities. These qualities enable them to effectively support healthcare professionals and enhance libraries' roles within medical institutions.

Similarly, academic librarianship encompasses a diverse range of professional skills, including information literacy instruction, reference management, and educational outreach. Librarians view themselves as integral educators and collaborators; there is often a disconnect between their self-perceptions and those of faculty and students. This misalignment underscores the need to clarify and strengthen librarians' instructional and interdisciplinary roles (Fagan et al., 2021). Equipping LIS graduates with pedagogical and collaborative skills would therefore enhance their visibility and effectiveness within academic environments.

The emergence of data librarianship further underscores the expanding skill requirements in the profession. Asiq and Warraich (2023) identified a growing demand for librarians to develop competencies in data management, curation, and analytics to support institutional research and digital scholarship Despite this, many practitioners still lack adequate training in data-driven service . Addressing these gaps through targeted educational programs and practical exposure would empower LIS graduates to take on more complex and technologically advanced responsibilities, thereby elevating the standards of professional librarianship in the modern information ecosystem.

In the Philippine context, several studies have explored the alignment of librarianship skills with educational preparation and workplace demands. Experiential learning through practicum significantly enhances BLIS students' professional competencies, particularly in library operations and digital tool usage (Zarghani et al., 2021). BLIS curriculum aligns with the National Competency-Based Standards for Filipino Librarians; there remain skill gaps in advanced specialization areas (Sajona 2024). Discrepancies between graduate competencies and employer expectations suggesting the need for curriculum enhancement (Asid, 2024b).

Further, Manuel (2024) revealed moderate levels of technical competency among public librarians in cataloging and classification, indicating a need for ongoing training. Likewise, Bacani (2021) argued for continuous curriculum updates to strengthen digital and service-oriented skills among LIS students. Collectively, these local studies emphasize the importance of aligning educational training with evolving professional skill requirements in librarianship within the Philippines.

Attitudes and Values Needed in the Workplace

In the contemporary library and information environment, the role of the librarian extends beyond technical proficiency to embodying professional values such as empathy, ethics, and expertise. These three elements are considered the core pillars that determine a librarian's effectiveness and success in serving users. According to Ashikuzzaman (2025), empathy allows librarians to understand and respond to the needs of patrons, ethics ensures that they uphold integrity and confidentiality in information management, and expertise enables them to provide accurate and reliable services. Balancing these values is therefore essential in maintaining both professionalism and user satisfaction.

Attitudes and values significantly influence the level of professionalism and overall productivity of employees, particularly in the field of library and information science. As emphasized by Chukwujindu et al. (2024), positive workplace attitudes such as responsibility, respect, and accountability foster collaboration, motivation, and commitment to high-quality service delivery. Conversely, negative attitudes can impede cooperation and diminish morale, leading to poor organizational outcomes. Thus, cultivating a positive work attitude among librarians is vital in promoting ethical conduct and a harmonious workplace culture.

Furthermore, studies have shown that poor work attitudes can lead to job dissatisfaction and declining performance among library personnel. Akpevwogho and Ojohwogho (2025) observed that librarians in universities in Delta State, Nigeria, exhibited low work motivation due to inadequate funding, insufficient infrastructure, and limited professional development opportunities. These findings underscore the importance of nurturing positive workplace values and creating environments conducive to professional growth factors that can equally be relevant for library professionals in the Philippine context.

The quality of library services is also greatly influenced by the attitudes of librarians toward their work and their patrons. found that librarians' attitudes directly affect user engagement and patronage levels in university libraries. A motivated and service-oriented librarian transforms the library into an active and vibrant learning hub, whereas negative attitudes may turn it into an underutilized space. This emphasizes the need for educational institutions to instill positive professional attitudes among students even before they enter the workforce (Michael and Olalekan, 2023).

Nze and Achugbue (2024) similarly stressed that attitudes and values—such as integrity, accountability, and dedication—serve as guiding principles for ethical decision-making within library institutions. These values reinforce a professional culture that prioritizes service quality, collaboration, and ethical conduct. Such principles not only benefit the institution but also contribute to the broader mission of libraries as agents of social and educational transformation.

Professional ethics and values are indispensable to the identity of librarianship. Attributes such as honesty, fairness, and commitment to service ensure that librarians maintain institutional trust and user-centered service. Moreover, maintaining a positive attitude encourages continuous learning and adaptability—skills that are increasingly necessary in today's rapidly changing information environment. These findings suggest that curricula in library and information science should place greater emphasis on ethical formation and value-based education (Dutta ,2023).

Illori et al. (2025) also pointed out that positive staff attitudes enhance cooperation, promptness, and efficiency in meeting user needs, while negative attitudes hinder communication and service delivery. Reinforcing workplace values such as respect, discipline, and responsibility ensures unity among employees and strengthens adherence to institutional policies. These

insights imply that workplace effectiveness in libraries is deeply tied to the interpersonal and ethical values of the staff.

In the Philippine context, a study by Santos and Villanueva (2022) on the work ethics of library and information professionals in state universities in Luzon revealed that values such as genuine concern, interpersonal harmony, and cooperation remain influential in shaping librarians' workplace behavior. These local values foster a culture of empathy and teamwork, aligning with global professional standards in librarianship. Integrating such cultural values into the BLIS curriculum can thus enhance graduates' readiness to adapt to both local and international work environments.

Civil Status

The civil status (or marital status) of employees is a recognized factor that can influence various aspects of professional life, including productivity, performance, stress management, work engagement, and work-life balance (Bakare and Bakare, 2024). Research specifically within the library profession highlights several complex and varied relationships between civil status and professional outcomes, suggesting that an individual's partnership status is not a neutral variable in the workplace.

A key finding related to professional output indicates a positive correlation between being partnered and research productivity among librarians. Specifically, librarians who are partnered generally show higher research productivity compared to those who are unpartnered or who did not disclose their civil status. This superior output includes publishing more and having better overall results. However, this advantage does not extend to all professional activities, as

conference presentations are reported to be the same for both partnered and unpartnered groups (Hoffmann et al., 2023).

The influence of marital status on task performance and perceived effectiveness often shows a significant gender bias. Traditional and sometimes persistent beliefs in many workplaces suggest that marriage improves men's performance, viewing married men as more responsible and reliable. Conversely, married women are sometimes viewed as less effective because of perceived or actual motherhood responsibilities. Single employees, regardless of gender, are frequently considered more productive as they are believed to have fewer personal obligations and, consequently, an ability to work longer hours (Oyedipe & Popoola, 2022).

The relationship between civil status and work engagement has also been explored, particularly in the context of post-COVID-19 flexible work environments. One study found that marital status did affect one specific dimension of work engagement, known as absorption. Notably, the presence of children did not show a corresponding effect on work engagement in this context (Çemberci et al., 2022) This indicates a nuanced influence where the state of being married or partnered can uniquely shape how an employee immerses themselves in their work.

Furthermore, civil status significantly impacts work-life balance. For library professionals, particularly given that many are married women, their marital status is suggested to influence how effectively they can balance job demands with their personal life. This balance is considered a factor that ultimately affects their role in the overall success of academic libraries (Kavitha, 2024).

Despite its influence on performance and work-life balance, civil status does not appear to be a significant factor in all professional areas. One study focusing on stress management among librarians found that while income strongly affected how librarians manage stress, civil status did

not have a significant influence. The recommendation resulting from this finding was to design stress management programs that are inclusive and applicable to all librarians, irrespective of their marital status (Marcus, Nyong & Ntui, 2025).

Finally, demographic data suggests that the majority of library workers are married. For instance, a study in Nigerian federal universities reported that 83.4% of librarians were married, with a smaller portion being single (15.6%) and very few being divorced, separated, or widowed (Ogunmodede & Popoola, 2024). Similarly, Das and Rajini (2024) a broader analysis of library employees found 62.4% were married and 36.6% were single. This high prevalence of married status highlights the practical importance of considering its effects on a substantial portion of the librarian workforce.

Year Graduated

The year of graduation is a significant factor in tracing the employability and career paths of Library and Information Science (LIS) graduates, as demonstrated by various studies across different regions and time periods. This factor has been explored concerning employment outlook, job market challenges, and career progress following the completion of LIS programs. Research efforts have been specifically directed toward tracing graduates from programs such as the Diploma and Bachelor of Library and Information Science (LIS), the BLIS Program of Leyte Normal University, and the Master of Science in Library and Information Science (MSLIS). The overall goal of such tracer studies is often to assess the relevance of the education received to current jobs and to provide a basis for curriculum enhancement.

The employment outlook for librarian graduates has demonstrably varied depending on the year they graduated. For instance, earlier graduates, such as those entering the workforce during the period spanning the Great Recession, often faced weaker prospects, and many

realized that while their degree was necessary, a lack of practical experience limited their opportunities. A notable example is the 2016–2017 projection by the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS), which showed only 2% job growth for librarians between 2012–2024, a rate that was below the national average (Torres et al., 2022a). Conversely, projections for later cohorts, such as graduates from 2019–2029, showed an improvement by 2021 with a projected growth rate of 5% higher than average (Torres et al., 2022b). These shifting projections highlight how the year an individual graduate can directly affect their initial employment opportunities among librarians.

Several tracer studies have specifically used the year of graduation to frame their analysis of LIS graduates' career outcomes. A study on Diploma and BLIS graduates from Mzuzu University, Malawi, focused on cohorts from 2005–2015 (Chipeta & Chawinga, 2023a). This research examined how their graduation year is related to their career paths, the relevance of their education, and their perceptions of the LIS curriculum (Chipeta & Chawinga, 2023b). Similarly, an investigation into MSc LIS graduates from the National University of Science and Technology (NUST), Zimbabwe, centered on the 2006–2013 graduating classes (Mugwisi & Hikwa, 2023). It examined the relationship between their graduation year and their workplaces, roles, competencies, and how well their education met employer expectations.

Data collected on more recent graduates indicates positive employment outcomes, though challenges persist. Of a study's 478 respondents, where the majority came from the 2017–2019 batches, 69.6% were gainfully employed in a job either regular or full-time related to their specialization (Victorino et al., 2022a). Furthermore, 57.1% of these respondents had achieved a regular or permanent position in their present employment (Victorino et al., 2022b). The graduates from the BLIS program of Leyte Normal University, which had 180 students finishing the

program from 2013 to 2019, are employed in both public and private libraries and other agencies (Navarro & Sanita-Dalan, 2021).

The graduating class of 2020 faced significant and immediate challenges in the job market, largely due to the COVID-19 pandemic (Library Journal, 2021). For these LIS graduates, job opportunities were limited, some job offers were canceled, and workplaces rapidly adjusted to new operations, including online work, safety measures, and new processes (Library Journal, 2021). Despite these immediate obstacles, the graduates from 2020, upon completion of their four-year programs, initially held the belief that their acquired knowledge and skills would help them secure formal employment (Kula-Semos et al., 2020).

More recent cohorts have shown signs of stabilizing their career placements. A survey of 2022 graduates reported that most are employed, with approximately 63% working in libraries or other information science institutions (Library Journal, 2023a). This suggests a recovery or "holding steady" of the job market following the peak disruptions of the pandemic (Library Journal, 2023b). Graduates in general, regardless of their specific graduation year, are often employed in libraries where they may have previously completed their internship. For those who commit to their current employment, top considerations for staying longer include salaries and benefits (Victorino, Festijo and Rojo, 2022).

The evidence strongly suggests that the year of graduation is a crucial variable in analyzing LIS graduates' employment trajectories, impacting everything from the general job outlook to specific employment challenges and successes. Earlier graduates occasionally faced the realization that practical experience, alongside their necessary degree, limited their opportunities, (Okonoko et al., 2023) a finding that can serve as a basis for curriculum enhancement. Tracer studies that analyze cohorts across different graduation years provide essential data for understanding career

paths, validating the relevance of the LIS curriculum, and informing program modifications to better prepare future BLIS graduates for the evolving professional landscape.

Year of Employment

The marketability and employment outcomes of graduates, particularly those from the Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) program, are a critical area of study, with the 'year of employment' or time-to-job-placement serving as a key variable. The literature suggests a mixed, yet generally positive, landscape for recent graduates, indicating strong demand for their skills. Barrows (2025). employment among librarians saw a substantial increase, rising by over 27 percent in 2024. This surge, coupled with the finding that 26 percent of librarians hold a bachelor's degree as their highest educational attainment, strongly suggests ample demand and opportunity for recent BLIS graduates.

For those who actively pursue career opportunities, the transition from graduation to employment can be quite swift. A study by Sadueste et al. (2025c) specifically revealed that the majority of graduates surveyed were successfully employed within a month after graduation. This rapid placement highlights the employability of these graduates, especially when combined with the finding that they had also managed to pass the Librarian Licensure Examination and obtain their license within a year. This suggests that licensure, a common requirement in the field, doesn't necessarily present a significant barrier to initial employment.

Despite the overall positive outlook, data regarding post-graduate employment status can be "a mixed response." An investigation into the marketability of the M.Lib.I.Sc. (Master of Library and Information Science) course by Rani and Sharma (2021a) showed varied timelines for securing a job. Specifically, 10 (37.03%) students remained unemployed for less than 6 months after completing their degree. However, a smaller proportion of graduates experienced longer periods of unemployment, with three (11.1%) students unemployed for six months to one year.

The challenge of securing employment extended significantly for some, as the study further noted that eight (29.6%) students took as long as two years to obtain a job. This extended period for a notable fraction of graduates contributes to the view that the employment journey is complex and varied. This variability underscores the importance of examining factors that might contribute to earlier placement, which is highly relevant for a tracer study aimed at curriculum enhancement (Pachauri, 2023).

One proactive strategy identified to improve job placement involves the timing of the application process. Iglesias and Schirmer (2023) suggest that the overall survey of population findings point to the benefit of applying early for jobs, ideally four to seven months prior to graduation. Furthermore, this study emphasizes the value of gaining pre-professional employment in an academic library. These findings suggest that strategic preparation and early experience are key levers in reducing the time to employment, which BLIS students could incorporate into their graduation plans.

Ultimately, the literature confirms that year of employment is a multifaceted variable, influenced by strong market demand, individual licensure, the timing of job applications, and the nature of the first job. The findings across different studies from rapid placement within a month for most BLIS-related graduates up to two years for a portion of master's graduates (Rani and

Sharma 2021b)—provide a necessary framework for investigating the specific employment timeline and status of BLIS graduates, thereby informing recommendations for curriculum enhancement.

Employment Status

The employment status of Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) graduates demonstrates a general trend toward successful job placement, high job conformity with the field, and increasing opportunities, though challenges related to unemployment and compensation disparities persist. Graduates from the BLIS program, such as those from the BLIS tracer study (Cartagena et al., 2020), have reported being employed after graduation and finding their curriculum 100% relevant to their current profession. Similarly, a study by Ismail and Khan (2021) found that 97.5% of their respondents are currently working.

Additionally, the demand for Library and Information Science graduates is noted, particularly in academic institutions, where a scarcity of licensed librarians leads Higher Education Institutions to hire even fresh graduates and non-license to man their libraries. Data consistently indicates a high degree of job conformity for BLIS graduates, meaning their employment aligns closely with their scientific field. The Airlangga (2020) states that more than 56% of graduates who are successfully tracked have a degree of job conformity with a high graduate profile, namely many of them work as librarian both in college libraries, school libraries and public libraries, in addition, also work as archivists in both government agencies and private companies.

Data from tracking graduates shows the distribution of graduate jobs in 2016 by 19% working as librarians and archivists. Similarly, Gregorios (2021) for the distribution of graduate employment data in 2017 was 22% as librarians and archivists. As well as the distribution of data on the suitability of graduate jobs in 2018, 15% of graduates work as librarians and archivists. Furthermore, the analysis further reveals that 19(70.37%) students are working in the same field, Library and Information Science, and 2(7.40%) are working in other fields such as corporate jobs and clerical jobs.

Regarding the sector of employment, BLIS graduates are found in both private and public sectors. A study of Sadueste et al., (2025d) revealed that BLIS graduates mainly employed full-time in private institutions after graduation, often as one-man librarians. Their job responsibilities were directly related to their profession, including cataloging and classification, referencing, collection development, processing library requests, book evaluation, and general library administration. Asid (2024c) findings show that almost all of the identified Library and Information Science graduates are working particularly in the school and university libraries with the rank of three head librarians, sixteen librarians, three library staff without licenses, and the two others who are classified in the teaching position as teacher-librarian and a teacher. A survey by Rani and Sharma (2021) revealed that out of 27 students, 21(77.7%) were in the job. Further, out of 21 students, 12 (44.44%) are working in the private sector and 9 (33.33%) are doing jobs in the public sector.

The nature of employment for graduates is often stable and swift. Ismail and Khan (2021) reported that 87.5% have permanent or regular status. The time taken for graduates to secure their first post-graduation job is relatively short, as 65% waited less than three months to be hired after graduation. Moreover, 70% had their first post-graduation job in professional, technical, or

supervisory positions. More recent data, Allard (2020a) shows an expansion of full-time and permanent employment opportunities.

Despite the positive employment trends, certain issues remain problematic in the field. Overall, both the data and the related literature make it apparent that employment rates dropped significantly over the period of 2008-2020, and that this situation continues to be a problematic issue in the field of Cabonero (2023).However, continued unemployment levels and other variables such as gender-related compensation disparities have continued to be causes of concern. According to Allard (2020b) “Many indicators, such as salary levels and full-time appointments, are moving in a positive direction for the class of 2019, however there are also areas for concern, such as unemployment levels and increasing gender salary disparity”. In the same study, Allard (2020) points out that the landscape of librarianship will see drastic changes in graduate support, as well as potential hiring freezes due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study is anchored on Donald Super's Theory of Career Development (1957), Yorke and Knight's Theory of Employability (2004), and Selznick's Core Competency Theory (1957). Collectively, these three theories explain how KSAV contributes to employability and curriculum enhancement within the context of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Donald Super's theory emphasizes that career development is a lifelong process shaped by an individual's self-concept, life roles, and personal experiences. It suggests that as individuals progress through various stages of life and work, they continuously develop and refine their knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values (KSAV), which are essential for career adaptability and employability (Super, 1957). Super's framework highlights that a strong self-concept and continuous learning foster an individual's ability to succeed and remain relevant in an ever-changing professional landscape.

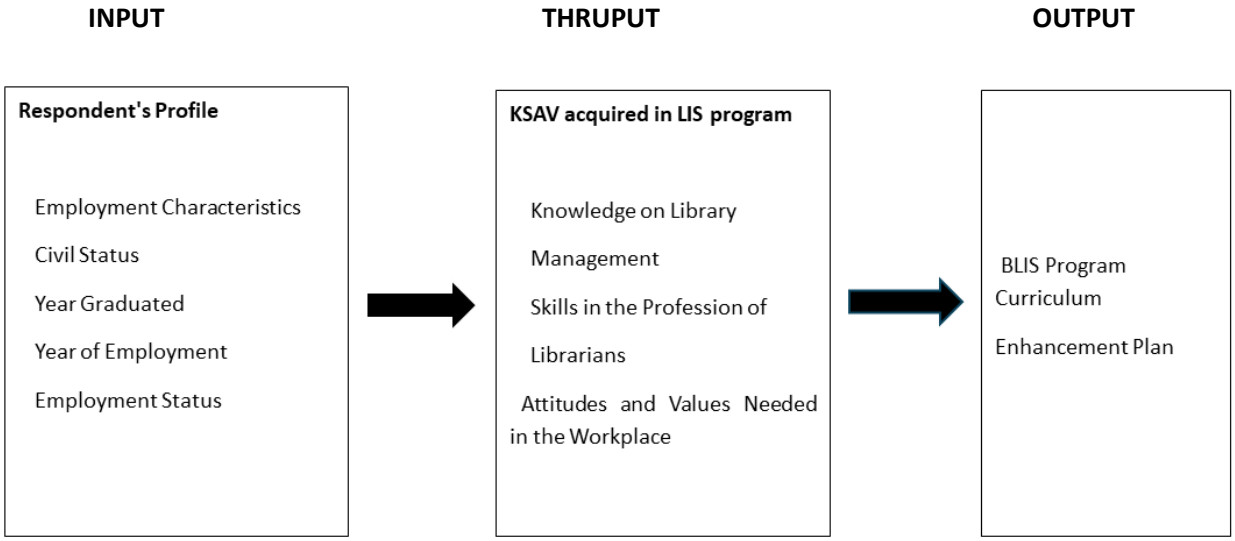
Meanwhile, Yorke and Knight's (2004) Theory of Employability specifically their USEM model—conceptualizes employability as a combination of Understanding, Skills, Efficacy beliefs, and Metacognition. These components parallel the KSAV framework: Knowledge corresponds to understanding, Skills to both technical and transferable abilities, Attitudes to efficacy beliefs such as confidence, motivation, and self-efficacy, and Values to metacognition, which involves reflection, ethics, and self-awareness. Their model asserts that employability extends beyond technical expertise to include the personal, reflective, and adaptive capacities that enable graduates to succeed in complex work environments (Yorke & Knight, 2004). This theory assesses how well the BLIS program prepares graduates for employment and career advancement. By

examining the skills and knowledge gained during the program, the study aims to determine how these factors have influenced graduates' employability and success in their chosen careers.

Additionally, Selznick's (1957) Core Competency Theory emphasizes that sustainable success, whether for individuals or organizations, depends on the development and integration of distinct capabilities and values. Core competencies represent the unique combinations of knowledge, skills, and ethical values that provide a competitive advantage. In the context of employability, this theory suggests that graduates become more valuable in the labor market when their KSAV aligns with the competencies and professional standards demanded by their chosen careers. Moreover, the Core Competency theory was used in similar studies, and it was significantly successful in determining the LIS professional competencies for the South African academic sector (Raju, 2017). The current study applied this theory to assess the qualifications, experience, knowledge, abilities, and attitudes required by public libraries from LIS graduates.

Moreover, the theory significantly decides that the LIS education sector effectively equips LIS professionals with the needed and ever-changing competencies for the public library job market as one sub-sector of the LIS market. Thus, Together, these theories offer a framework to evaluate the effectiveness of the BLIS program and identify areas for curriculum improvement based on graduates' real-world experiences.

1.4 Schematic Diagram



1.5 Statement of the Problem

This study aims to trace the graduates of the Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) program. Further, the study will determine the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values (KSAV) acquire and the employability status of BLIS graduates. The findings of this tracer study will serve

as a basis for enhancing the BLIS curriculum to better meet the demands of the profession and the labor market.

Specifically, the study will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the respondents in terms of;

1.1 Employment Characteristics;

1.2 Civil status;

1.3 Year Graduated;

1.4 Year of Employment; and

1.5 Employment Status?

2.What is the relevance of the competencies acquired in college did the respondents applied in their professional practice;

2.1 Knowledge on library management;

2.2 Skills in the profession of librarianship; and

2.3 Attitudes and values needed in the workplace?

3. To what extent are the KSAV acquired from the BLIS program applied by the graduates in their current workplace?

4. How do the graduates' employment characteristics relate to the KSAV they have acquired during their BLIS education?

5. What aspects of the BLIS curriculum do the respondents find relevant and adequate in preparing them for their current employment?

1.6 Scope and Delimitation

This study will focus on Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from the academic years 2022 to 2025. It aims to evaluate the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values (KSAV) acquired during their academic training that have been applied in their job roles. The study will only focus on graduates of the BLIS program within the specified years and exclude alumni from the other programs and institutions. The results of this study will be used as a basis for curriculum enhancement to ensure that the BLIS program remains relevant to industry standards and graduate employability.

1.8 Definition of Terms

These are the following terms that will be used in the study operationally:

Attitudes and values. It refers to the proper behavior and values expected of BLIS graduates as professionals, such as professionalism, responsibility, teamwork, integrity, and adaptability.

Bachelor of Library and Information Science. A four-year program which equips students with skills and knowledge in information management, books and data organization, and information services.

Civil Status. It indicates the respondents' legal marital status, e.g., single, married, separated, or widowed. It is used to investigate whether their individual situations affect their employment search experience, occupational choice, and career readiness.

Curriculum Enhancement. This pertains to the enhancement or inclusion of subjects and courses to enhance students' skills. It is assessed in terms of BLIS graduates' recommendations on curriculum areas that need to be revised or improved to prepare them better for the profession.

Employability. It refers to the present employment status of BLIS graduates alongside their perceived level of preparedness and adaptability in response to job market demands.

Employment status. The respondents' current employment status, including being employed, unemployed, or underemployed. It is employed to analyze their involvement in the labor market and the impact it has had on their professional growth and prospects.

Knowledge of Library Management. It refers to the knowledge and skills of BLIS graduates in library management, including planning, organizing, collection development, services, and the use of library systems.

Resource and capability skills. This pertains to respondents' capability to efficiently utilize the equipment, technology, and information required in the profession. It is measured according to their competence in utilizing library resources, systems, and equipment in order to achieve their responsibilities.

Skills in the profession of librarianship. It refers to the practical skills of BLIS graduates in performing library functions such as cataloging, reference services, information organization, user assistance, and the use of library technologies.

System technology skills. It refers to the knowledge, creativity, and abilities connected to using and functioning with various technological systems and tools that will be acquired by the graduates of the BLIS program at Saint Michael College of Caraga in 2022-2025.

Tracer Study. It refers to the process of gathering information from BLIS graduates on their current employment status, work experience, and how their academic background prepared them for their professional career.

Year of Employment. It refers to the year BLIS graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga started to work after graduation.

Year Graduated. It refers to the year BLIS students graduated at Saint Michael College of Caraga.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter explains the study's research design, the location of the study, the discussion about the respondents, the research instruments, the ethical considerations, the analysis wherein the data is gathered, and the statistical treatment

2.1 Research Design

This study will utilize an explanatory sequential mixed-method design. In this research, the quantitative method will be conducted first, followed by the qualitative method to further explain and support the findings. The quantitative phase will determine the relationship between

the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values (KSAV) acquired in the BLIS curriculum and the employability of graduates from academic years 2022 to 2025. Data will be gathered through a structured survey questionnaire and will analyze by the statistician to determine the significance of the relationships among variables. The qualitative component will complement the results by exploring the graduates' personal insights and experiences on how their KSAV were applied in their professional roles. Data will be collected through interviews, focus group discussions and analyzed thematically to provide a deeper understanding of the graduates' perspectives. were applied in their professional roles.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

This study will use a modified survey questionnaire, adapted from the work of Shongwe and Ocholla (2011) entitled A tracer study of LIS graduates at the University of Zululand, 2000-2009. The original instrument consisted of both structured and unstructured questions designed to capture the employability, knowledge, skills, and attitudes of LIS graduates. For this study, the questionnaire was contextualized to align with the BLIS curriculum.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

The research will be carried out at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), a Catholic institution administered by the Roman Catholic Diocese of Butuan. It was founded in 1948 by the SMI. Fathers and situated along Atupan, Street, Barangay 4, Poblacion**,** Nasipit, Agusan del Norte.

It has a second campus in Barangay Triangulo, catering to its elementary department. SMCC offers basic and tertiary educational programs and has expanded gradually since its humble beginning on July 1, 1948, its first director, Fr. Francisco Van Dyke. With its ongoing expansion and emphasis on learning, the institution wants to attain university status by 2035.

The study's respondents were determined using purposive sampling technique and they will be the graduates of Bachelor of Library and information science from 2022-2025 of Saint Michael College of Caraga. In addition, the study has a total of 38 respondents, where twelve (12) of the respondents were graduates from the year 2022; six (6) graduates from the year 2023; ten (10) graduates for the year 2024; and ten (10) graduates from the year 2025**.** Therefore, the study will be using a purposive sampling technique to answer.

Table 1. The Distribution of the Respondents of the Study

BLIS	Male		Female		Total	
	F	%	F	%	F	%
2022	2	5.26	10	26.32	12	31.58
2023	0	0.00	6	15.79	6	15.79
2024	1	2.63	9	23.68	10	26.32
2025	0	0.00	10	26.32	10	26.32
Total	**3**	**7.89**	**35**	**92.11**	**38**	**100**

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

To begin the process, a formal letter was addressed to the office of the college Registrar of Saint Michael College of Caraga requesting permission to obtain the official list of BLIS graduates. The list includes the name, year graduated, and available contact information of alumni who would serve as potential respondents for the study. Another letter was also submitted to the Dean of College of Computing and Information Sciences and to the research adviser to seek approval to

conduct the study to ensure that the research would comply with institutional policies and ethical standards.

After securing the approval, the researchers coordinated the learning Resource Center to assist in locating and communicating with BLIS graduates. The cooperation of faculty members and former class advisers was also sought to help reach alumni who were no longer actively connected to the institution, through these coordinated efforts, the researchers were able to identify and contact enough graduates who were willing to participate in the study.

Frequency and Percentage Distribution. It will describe the profile of Bachelor of Library and Information Science graduates and their employment status from 2022 to 2025.

Distribution. The researchers will distribute the questionnaire to BLIS graduates of SMCC from batches 2022 to 2025 using both online and offline methods. The online form will be shared through email and messenger, while printed copies will be provided to graduates within the locality. In addition, selected participants will be invited for follow-up interviews to obtain qualitative data that will complement the survey results.

Weighted mean. It will be used to determine the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and value is acquired by the respondents from the BLIS program in terms of knowledge on library management, skills in the profession of librarianship, attitudes and values needed in the workplace.

Pearsons Product Correlation. It will determine the significant relationship between the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values (KSAV) acquired by the BLIS graduates, and how these relate to the curriculum alignment with their present job requirements.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The research will consider the protection of intellectual property rights. No new technologies, processes, or products will be developed that would require patent protection. All original materials produced, such as survey instruments and data analysis tools, are protected under Philippine copyright law. Any third-party sources used, such as existing literature or secondary data, were properly cited, ensuring respect for the intellectual property of others while safeguarding the researcher's own contributions. Since the study did not involve the creation of a brand, logo, or symbol, trademark registration was not applicable.

B. Informed Consent

Participants will be the graduates of BLIS program from Saint Michael College of Caraga, were provided with a detailed explanation of the research's purpose, the methods used, potential risks, and anticipated benefits before agreeing to participate. Written consent forms were distributed to ensure that participants fully understood their rights, including the right to withdraw from the study at any time without negative consequences. The consent form was written in accessible

language. As the study did not involve animal or living organism trials, no additional ethical approval for animal welfare was necessary.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

This research strictly follows the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173) in the Philippines. Participants' personal data, such as names and demographic information, will be collected with explicit consent. All data will be anonymized to ensure privacy, and no identifiable information will be used in the final report. Data will be securely stored in password-protected digital files, and physical copies will be kept in locked cabinets accessible only to the research team. Anonymized data may be shared with authorized third parties for academic purposes but only with the participant's consent and in compliance with ethical and legal requirements.

D. Voluntary Participation

Participation in this study will be entirely voluntary. Participants will be fully informed of their right to withdraw. No undue pressure, incentives, or coercion will be used to recruit participants. Since the study did not involve animal participants, ethical standards related to animal research will not be applicable.

E. Minimization of Harm

A risk assessment will be conducted to ensure that participants will not experience any physical, psychological, or emotional harm. Participants will be informed of their right to discontinue their participation at any point if they feel uncomfortable. Support services will be made available if needed. Since no animals were involved, the 3Rs principle (Replacement, Reduction, and Refinement) was not applicable.

F. Beneficence

This research aimed to benefit the academic community by offering insightful findings that can be used to improve the Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) program curriculum. The aim of this research is to identify strengths and areas for improvement in the present curriculum by analyzing graduates' experiences and professional outcomes and ensuring that it is relevant and responsive to current industry expectations. Furthermore, participants will be able to access the study's findings upon request, encouraging transparency and ethical information distribution.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants will be selected based on fair and transparent inclusion and exclusion criteria. The selection process will ensure diversity and represent the study's population, with no group being unfairly burdened or excluded. The sample will be drawn from the BLIS graduates' population, ensuring that the findings are broadly applicable.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standardized methods will be followed to collect and analyze data, ensuring accuracy and reliability. The research team will take measures to prevent errors or bias in data collection and interpretation. Limitations of the study, such as sample size and potential biases, were acknowledged in the final report to maintain transparency and credibility.

I. Transparency in Reporting

All findings from the research will be reported truthfully, and no data manipulation will occur. Potential conflicts of interest will be disclosed, and all third-party materials, such as literature or tools, will be properly cited to respect intellectual property rights.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The study will not involve the use of patented technologies. However, copyrighted materials, such as academic literature and secondary data sources, will be used, and all necessary permissions will be obtained. Proper citations will be included in the final report to acknowledge these sources and ensure compliance with copyright laws.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The research will focus solely on human participants (graduates). Participants will be fully informed of the risks and benefits of participation. Since the research posed no significant risks, no additional medical or psychological support will be required. Ethical clearance for animal use was not applicable, as the study did not involve animals.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

The study will incorporate AI tools and digital technologies to assist in various stages of the research process. ChatGPT will be utilized during the preliminary analysis phase for organizing thoughts and summarizing initial findings. Grammarly will ensure that the research report adhered to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of these technologies will involve validating AI-generated outputs and ensuring that no AI tools introduce bias or misinterpretation. Respondents will be informed about the use of these technologies to ensure full transparency and trust in the research process.

M. Ethical Approval

The research will receive ethical approval from the institutional review board of Saint Michael College of Caraga, ensuring it meets guidelines for participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

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CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: SHEILA JOYCE M. ROSAL
ADDRESS: Poblacion 3, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: sheilajoyce_rosal@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : February 16, 2005
Height : 5'5
Weight : 52kg
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Buenavista Central Elementary School
Secondary : Buenavista Special Education High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Local Student Government S.Y 2024-2025	**2nd Year BLIS Representative**
Local Student Government S.Y 2025-2026	**3rd Year BLIS Representative (2025-2026)**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: EMIRALD V. SABANDAL
ADDRESS: Afga, Lower Olave, Buenavista, Agusal del Norte
EMAIL: sabandalemirald@gmail.com

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : June 04, 2004
Height : 4'11 ft
Weight : 40kg
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Olave Elementary School
Secondary : Sangay National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITA



NAME: LEAH MAE D. DELAPENA
ADDRESS: Upper Olave, Lower Olave, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: sabandalemirald@gmail.com

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : May 01, 2005
Height : 4'11 ft
Weight : 47kg
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Olave Elementary School
Secondary : Sangay National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliation

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Future Librarian and Information Scientists' Society (FLISS) S.Y 2023-2024	**Business Manager**
Future Librarian and Information Scientists' Society (FLISS) S.Y 2024-2025	**P.I.O**
Future Librarians and Information Scients' Society (FLISS) S.Y 2025-2026	**President**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: MARY GRACE T. OUAN0
ADDRESS: P-6 barangay 17 Portpoyohon, Butuan City
EMAIL: marygrace_ouano@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : May 10, 2004
Height : 5'5 ft
Weight : 47kg
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Obrero Elementary School
Secondary : Butuan City School of Arts and Trades
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliation

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: KIMBERLY T. RODRIGUEZ
ADDRESS: Purok-1 Sangay Buenavista, Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: ylrebmikrodriguez05@gmail.com
Personal Information

Sex : Female



Date of birth : April 11, 2005
Height : 5’4 ft
Weight : 50kg
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Sangay Elementary School
Secondary : Sangay National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliation

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDICES

A - Letter of Approval with Certificate of Appearance and Photo



Saint Michael College of Caraga
Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines
Tel. Nos. +63 085 343-3251 / +63 085 283-3113 Fax No. +63 085 808-0892
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

September 17, 2025
MR. CECILIO C. ARRIOLA
Office of the Registrar
Saint Michael College of Caraga

Dear Mr. Arriola,

Greetings of peace and prosperity! With due respect, I am writing to request permission to obtain the list of graduates from the Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) program for the academic years 2022 to 2025 at Saint Michael College of Caraga. This information will serve as the basis for identifying respondents in our research entitled "**A Tracer Study of BLIS Graduates: Basis for Curriculum Enhancement**."

We assure you that all information will be treated with the utmost confidentiality. The data collected will be used strictly for academic and research purposes only.

We sincerely hope you will consider this request favorably, as your support will significantly contribute to the success and reliability of our study.

Thank you for your time and kind consideration.

Respectfully yours

Sheila Joyce Rosal
Group leader

Noted by:

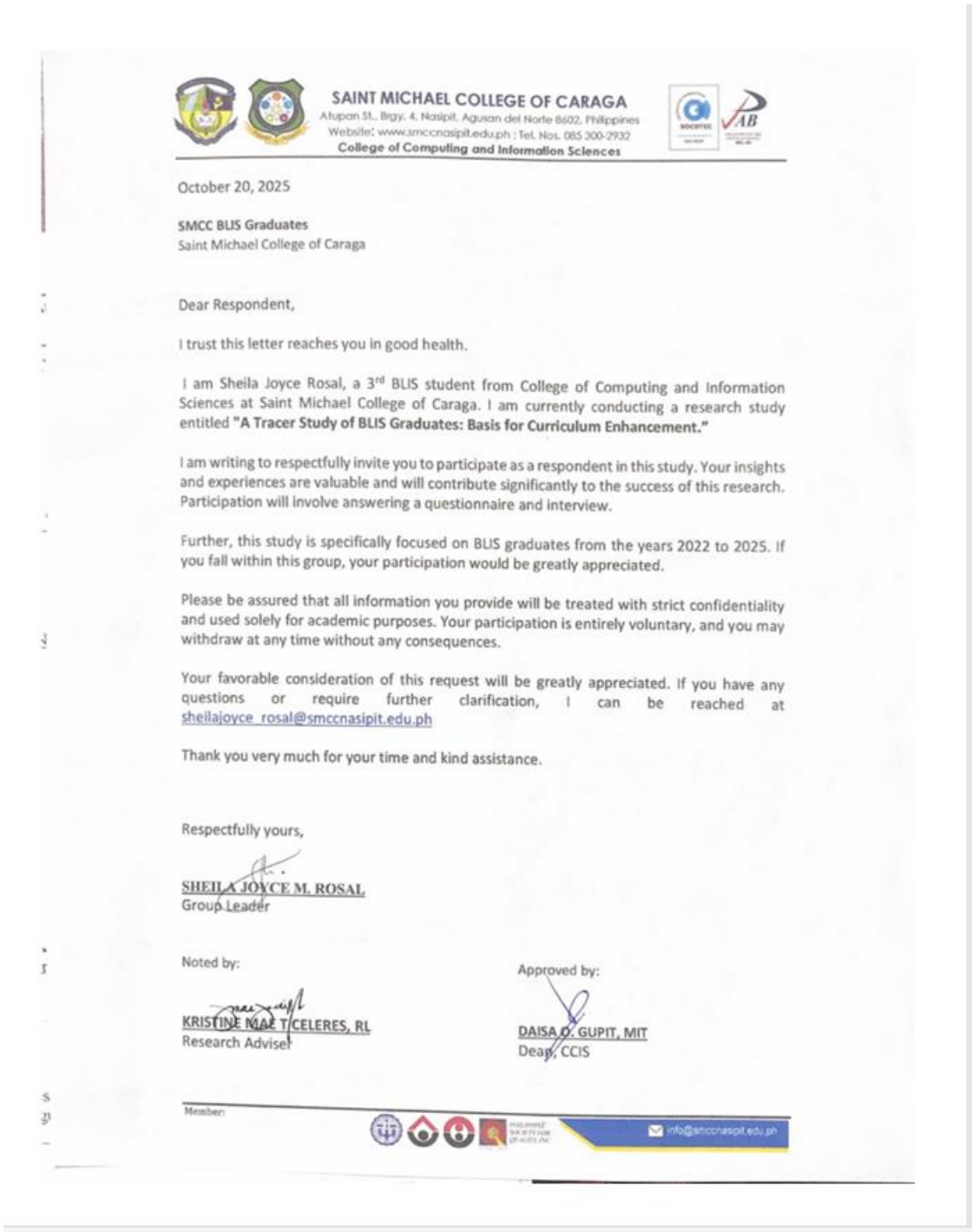
Dr. Beverly D. Jaminal
Research Instructor

Kristine Mae T. Celeres, RL
Research adviser

Approved by:

Cecilio C. Arriola
Head of the Registrar

Member: info@smccnasipit.edu.ph



SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
Atupan St., Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte 8602, Philippines
Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph : Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932
College of Computing and Information Sciences

October 20, 2025

SMCC BLIS Graduates
Saint Michael College of Caraga

Dear Respondent,

I trust this letter reaches you in good health.

I am Sheila Joyce Rosal, a 3rd BLIS student from College of Computing and Information Sciences at Saint Michael College of Caraga. I am currently conducting a research study entitled **"A Tracer Study of BLIS Graduates: Basis for Curriculum Enhancement."**

I am writing to respectfully invite you to participate as a respondent in this study. Your insights and experiences are valuable and will contribute significantly to the success of this research. Participation will involve answering a questionnaire and interview.

Further, this study is specifically focused on BLIS graduates from the years 2022 to 2025. If you fall within this group, your participation would be greatly appreciated.

Please be assured that all information you provide will be treated with strict confidentiality and used solely for academic purposes. Your participation is entirely voluntary, and you may withdraw at any time without any consequences.

Your favorable consideration of this request will be greatly appreciated. If you have any questions or require further clarification, I can be reached at sheilajoyce_rosal@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Thank you very much for your time and kind assistance.

Respectfully yours,

SHEILA JOYCE M. ROSAL
Group Leader

Noted by:

KRISTINE MAE T. CELERES, RL
Research Adviser

Approved by:

DAISA O. GUPIT, MIT
Dean, CCIS

Member:

info@smccnasipit.edu.ph

B - Instrument with Informed Consent

Saint Michael College of Caraga
Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines
Tel. Nos. +63 085 343-3251 / +63 085 283-3113 Fax No. +63 085 808-0892
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

INFORMED CONSENT FORM

Title of the Study:
"A Tracer Study of BLIS Graduates" Basis for Curriculum Enhancement"

Dear Respondent,

We, the researchers, conducted a study entitled "A Tracer Study of BLIS Graduates: Basis for Curriculum Enhancement" as part of our academic requirements for the Bachelor of Library and Information Science program. The purpose of this research is to evaluate the outcomes of BLIS graduates after completing their academic program.

We are writing to respectfully invite you to participate as a respondent in this study. Your insights and experiences are valuable and will contribute significantly to the success of this research. Participation will involve answering a questionnaire and interview.

Please be assured that all information you provide will be treated with strict confidentiality and used solely for academic purposes. Your participation is entirely voluntary, and you may withdraw at any time without any consequences.

CONSENT STATEMENT
By checking the box below or signing your name, you are indicating that;

- You have read and understood the information above.
- You voluntarily agree to participate in this study.

☐ I have read and understood the information provided, and I voluntarily agree to participate in the study.

Participant's Name (Optional): _____
Date: _____

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SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE

Title of the Study:
"A Tracer Study of BLIS Graduates: Basis for Curriculum Enhancement"

Instruction: Please read each item carefully and put a check mark (✓) on the option that represents your answer.

Part I: Respondent's Profile

1. Employment Characteristics

- ❑ Current Employment Type
- ❑ Full-time
- ❑ Part-time
- ❑ Contractual
- ❑ Casual
- ❑ Self-employed
- ❑ Unemployed
- ❑ Others: _____

2. Current Position/Job Title

- ❑ Professional Librarian
- ❑ Library Assistant/Staff
- ❑ Cataloger/Indexer
- ❑ Records/Data Manager
- ❑ IT/Library Systems Personnel
- ❑ Information Officer
- ❑ Other: _____

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3. Nature of Institution

- ❑ Academic Library
- ❑ School Library
- ❑ Public Library
- ❑ Special Library
- ❑ Private/Corporate Sector
- ❑ Others: _____

4. Civil Status

- ❑ Single
- ❑ Married
- ❑ Separated
- ❑ Widow/Widower
- ❑ Prefer not to say

5. Year Graduated

- ❑ 2022
- ❑ 2023
- ❑ 2024
- ❑ 2025

6. Year of First Employment

- ❑ Same year as graduation
- ❑ 1 year after graduation
- ❑ 2 years after graduation
- ❑ More than 2 years after graduation

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7. Employment Status

- ❑ Permanent
- ❑ Temporary
- ❑ Probationary
- ❑ Contractual
- ❑ Unemployed

Part II: Relevance of competencies acquired

Instructions: Rate the relevance of each competency.

Scale: 4 – Highly Relevant | 3 – Relevant | 2 – Slightly Relevant | 1 – Not Relevant

Competency	4	3	2	1
Knowledge of library operations and services				
Understanding of collection development policies				
Knowledge of cataloging and classification rules				
Knowledge of reference and information services				
Understanding of library administration and budgeting				

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Skill	4	3	2	1
Cataloging & metadata				
ICT and digital skills				
Information literacy instruction				
Records and information management				
Communication and customer service skills				

Attitude/Value	4	3	2	1
Professional ethics and integrity				
Teamwork and collaboration				
Service orientation				
Adaptability and flexibility				
Initiative and responsibility				

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Part III: Extent of KSAV application in the Workplace

Instructions: Using the same scale (1–4), rate how much the KSAV (Knowledge, Skills, Attitudes, and Values) you acquired from BLIS are applied in your current job.

KSAV Dimension	4	3	2	1
Knowledge (Library science theories & concepts)				
Skills (Technical & Soft skills)				
Attitudes (Professional Behavior)				
Values (Work ethics, service, professionalism)				

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Part IV: Perceived Relevance and Adequacy of the BLIS Curriculum

Instructions: Check (✓) the most appropriate response or write your answer when needed.

A. Curriculum Adequacy

1. Which components of the BLIS curriculum prepare you well for your job? (You may check more than one.)

- ❑ Cataloging and Classification
- ❑ Reference and Information Services
- ❑ Collection Development
- ❑ Library Management
- ❑ ICT in Libraries
- ❑ Research Methods
- ❑ Practicum/On-the-Job Training
- ❑ GenEd courses
- ❑ Others (specify): _____

Part V: Open Ended Questions

1. Which BLIS subjects did you find most relevant to your current job role?

_____

2. Do you feel the BLIS curriculum equipped you with adequate technical skills (cataloging, ICT, reference services)? Why or why not?

_____

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3. What skills did your job require that you feel were not adequately covered in the BLIS curriculum?

_____

4. What new subjects or topics should be added to the BLIS curriculum to meet industry demands?

_____

5. Would you recommend improvements to the curriculum based on your employment experience? Why?

_____

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Title of the Study:
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CONSENT STATEMENT
By checking the box below or signing your name, you are indicating that;

- You have read and understood the information above.
- You voluntarily agree to participate in this study.

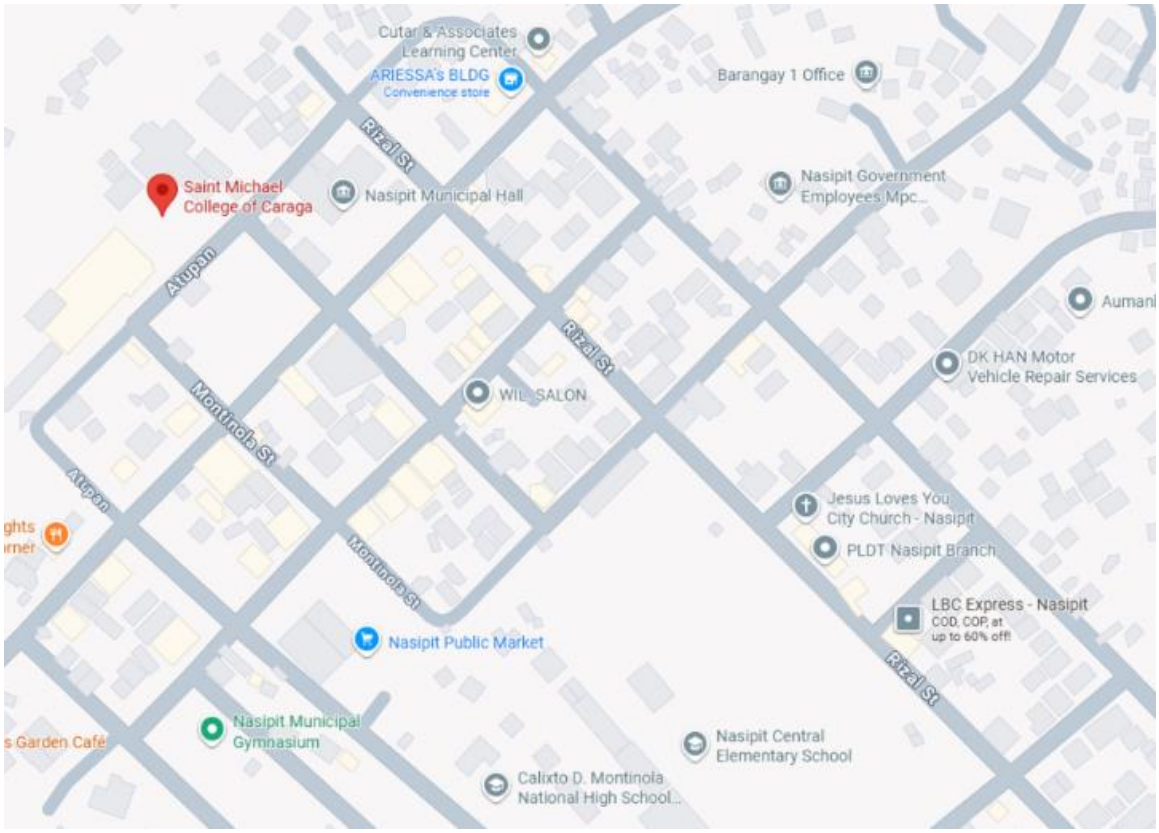
☐ I have read and understood the information provided, and I voluntarily agree to participate in the study.

Participant's Name (Optional): _____
Date: _____

Member:
info@smccnasipit.edu.ph

C - Map of the Research Locale *(Include Coordinates)*

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA



D- Narrative & Photo Documentation





E- Ethics Committee Approval

CERTIFICATE OF TECHNOLOGY ASSESSMENT

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
Atupan St., Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte 8602, Philippines
Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph ; Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932

TEST RESULT

TECHNOLOGY-BASED QUALITY ASSURANCE

Date of Test	November 5, 2025	**Control number**	RBLIS125002	
Research Title	**A TRACER STUDY OF BLIS GRADUATES: BASIS FOR CURRICULUM ENHANCEMENT**			
Author (s)	1	Sheila Joyce M. Rosal	**ORCID No.**	0009-0008-3310-7126
	2	Emirald V. Sabandal	**ORCID No.**	0009-0005-5676-9155
	3	Leah Mae D. Delapeña	**ORCID No.**	0009-0000-8073-0916
	4	Mary Grace T. Ouano	**ORCID No.**	0009-0006-9532-3620
	5	Kimberly G. Rodruguez	**ORCID No.**	0009-0005-9716-6836
Co-author (s)	1	Kristine Mae Celeres	**ORCID No.**	0000-0003-4641-4025

Contact Person	Sheila Joyce Rosal
Address	Poblacion 3 Buenavista Agusan del Norte
Mobile Number	09154735193

Test subject	Chapters 1-2				
Total number of words	4,658	**Sentences**	320	**Characters**	31,384

	Test Area	Score	Required	Remarks
	(1) Plagiarism	98	90%	PASSED
	(2) Grammar	98	95%	PASSED
	(3) Readability Score	42	25%	PASSED
	(4) AI Text Detection	23	40%	PASSED
	(5) Reliability *(Test Instrument only)*	N/A	N/A	

FINDING(S) & RECOMMENDATION(S)

Evaluated by:	Approved by:
MICHELLE ANN G. LUCINO	**KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, MA**
Signature over Printed Name	Head of Research

Member:

Email: communications@smccnasipit.edu.ph

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP

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Signed this
Date:
Location:

Author(s):

Sheila Joyce M. Rosal
Author

Emirald V. Sabandal
Author

Leah Mae D. Delapena
Author

Mary Grace T. Ouano
Author

Kimberly G. Rodriguez
Author